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The Medicalization of Women's Experiences: Proposal and Annotated

Bibliography

## **Proposal**

Blog option 2:

My phenomenon is "The Gender Pain Gap" and Patient Dismissal in Women's Mental Health. To my current understanding, the "Gender Pain Gap" is the tendency of healthcare workers to ignore women's physical/chronic pain, and psychological symptoms. When these symptoms are presented that are oftentimes attributed to general anxiety disorders, emotional distress, and depression, when in reality they require serious medical treatment. One of the strongest patterns I have observed is the dismissal of calls for help from women struggling with mental health disorders. In "The Yellow Wallpaper," the woman consistently tells her husband that her condition does not seem to be improving and that she is starting to feel increasingly isolated because of the "treatment" she is receiving. John, her husband, brushes this off almost instantly when she informs him. I felt that the same pattern was repeating itself in the earlier ads we saw in the ad collection. Although the ads are advertising a drug to help with anxiety

and depression, they don't give a name to the disorder, which was most likely post-partum depression or even psychosis. This pattern of constant dismissal of calls suggests that there is a definite research opportunity and phenomenon concerning the "Gender Pain Gap" and Patient Dismissal in Women's Mental Health. Although I believe I have found a strong pattern, I could be assuming there is a lack of concern when it comes to women's mental health, especially when the ads come into question. I did question myself there because the ads are indeed selling a drug meant to help mental disorders specifically for women, but I believe I could build on my pattern. The three popular culture artifacts I have selected are a TikTok trend that revolved around "Late Diagnosed Female ADHD and Autism" in 2020, Strong Female Character by Fern Brady which was a memoir published in 2023, and The Bell Jar which was published in 1963 by Sylvia Path. In The Bell Jar, the Sylvia Path uses a lens that centers around feminism in the 1950s, which is when the book is set. This may complicate my interpretation because I did want to focus more on current issues in women's mental health treatment, but I do think it is essential for me to refer back to more historical pieces of literature in order to get an entire background on my phenomenon. I believe that the phenomenon I have chosen should give me a lot of material to work with and I am excited to do more research on the topic. While patient dismissal in women's mental health could be blamed individually on close-minded physicians, popular culture artifacts such as The Bell Jar show that this is not just a one time instance, it is a true bias that is rooted in the framework of women's healthcare.

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## **Annotated Bibliography**